

ORIENTATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT FOR NEW BOARD MEMBERS

The School Board shall establish a program to assist newly elected members, or a person designated for an appointment to fill a vacancy, to become fully informed about the school system and the Board's policies, procedures, functions, and protocols.

A. Interim New School Board Member. In the interim between election or appointment and assumption of office, the new member shall be invited to attend all public meetings and functions of the Board and shall receive all appropriate reports and communications normally sent to Board members, except communications protected by the attorney-client privilege or confidential.

B. Required Documentation. Within two weeks following election, reelection, or appointment, the Superintendent or designee shall furnish to the persons so elected, reelected, or appointed copies of the following from the Code of Virginia:

1. The State and Local Government Conflict of Interest Act;
2. The Virginia Freedom of Information Act; and
3. The Virginia Public Records Act.

Such persons shall read and become familiar with the materials provided.

C. New School Board Member Orientation. Within a 30-day period following election or appointment, the Chair shall work with the Superintendent or designee to schedule in-depth programming for newly elected or appointed School Board members for the primary purposes of orienting new members to their responsibilities, to the Board's method of operating, to the school division's policies, and to the overall operation of the school division. The Chair shall be responsible for approving the orientation programming and schedule and shall attend orientation sessions with the Superintendent, Staff, and other Board members. Newly elected or appointed School Board members are expected to attend this new School Board member orientation within a 30-day period following their election or appointment.

D. Records of Orientation Programming. Records shall be kept of any such orientation programming as are provided for in paragraph C. above, to assist the Board in meeting Standards of Quality, Standard 5. The records shall include the topics discussed.

E. Other Documentation. New School Board members shall be provided with appropriate publications, policy manuals, and regulations of the Board of Education of the Commonwealth of Virginia.

ORIENTATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT FOR NEW BOARD MEMBERS

[Former Policy 2-7, Orientation of New Board Members]

Adopted: 10/12/76

Revised: 6/22/93, 6/25/96, 9/22/09

[Former Policy 2-10, Professional Development]

Adopted: 6/22/93

Revised: 5/13/08, 9/22/09, 5/10/16, 11/30/21

Current Revision: 12/16/2025

Legal Refs: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended §§ [22.1-253.13:5](#); [2.2-3702](#);
[42.1-76.1](#); [2.2-3704.3](#);
Cross Ref: [Policy 2160, Conflict of Interest](#)